

Our Story

Built From Hard Work, Family, and Relationships Since 1996

Ray's Produce began in the mid-1990s with humble beginnings and a simple goal: work hard, provide dependable service, and build long-term relationships with customers.

Before the company officially existed, founder **Ray Sosa** started by selling strawberries out of the back of a truck throughout the local community. Shortly after, he worked at a local farm produce store stocking produce, where he learned the business firsthand and gained valuable knowledge about sourcing, quality, and customer demand.

Ray and his wife eventually opened a small neighborhood produce stand in Newberg, Oregon. At the time, the Hispanic food industry in the region was still small, and many Mexican restaurants struggled to find reliable access to produce and specialty ingredients needed to operate. Restaurant owners would frequently visit the produce stand asking for full cases of produce and hard-to-find products for their kitchens.

Recognizing the need, Ray began personally delivering products directly to local restaurants. What started as a few deliveries quickly became the foundation of what would eventually grow into the foodservice distribution business Ray's Produce is known for today.

The original produce stand remained open as the retail side of the company while delivery operations continued expanding. That original retail business still operates today and remains an important part of the company's history.

As demand grew, Ray and his wife purchased the neighboring house next to the produce stand. The property included a detached garage that became the company's very first office and warehouse. The front room served as office space while part of the garage was converted into a walk-in cooler and small loading operation. As business continued growing, operations expanded into the backyard under covered work areas to support additional inventory and deliveries.

In the early years, the business operated with only a handful of employees and family members helping with warehouse work, purchasing, deliveries, and customer service. Growth was not easy. Limited resources, minimal staffing, and constant reinvestment into the business made every step forward difficult.

One major turning point came when a fire damaged the small walk-in cooler at the original operation. That challenge forced the company to think bigger and accelerated the decision to expand into a dedicated warehouse facility.

Around 2006, Ray's Produce moved into its first official warehouse in Tualatin, Oregon. The company continued growing steadily as more restaurants trusted Ray's dependable service and consistent supply.

Over the years, the company expanded beyond produce and gradually became a full-service food distributor by adding dairy products, meats, dry goods, restaurant supplies, cleaning products, beverages, spices, packaging products, and foodservice essentials.

As the business continued growing, Ray's Produce expanded operations multiple times:

- **2006** — First official warehouse in Tualatin, Oregon
- **2013** — Expansion into a 12,000 square foot warehouse in Sherwood, Oregon

- **2016** — Purchase of a 40,000 square foot warehouse in Salem, Oregon
- **Today** — Operating from a 150,000 square foot distribution center in Salem, Oregon, owned by the company

The company also now operates a second retail store from one of its previous warehouse locations.

The growth of Ray's Produce was built through long hours, disciplined reinvestment into the business, and a commitment to taking care of customers through dependable service and strong relationships.

Today, Ray's Produce serves nearly **2,000 customers throughout the Pacific Northwest** and has grown into one of the region's leading independent foodservice distributors while continuing to maintain deep roots in the Hispanic food industry.

The company now employs **over 100 team members** across warehouse operations, transportation, purchasing, sales, office administration, and retail operations.

In recent years, Ray's Produce has continued expanding beyond traditional distribution.

The company launched its own tortilla program to support growing customer demand after local manufacturers struggled to maintain consistent supply availability.

Ray's Produce also launched **Restogo**, a private-label packaging and direct import division focused on importing disposable products directly from overseas while also creating custom branded packaging solutions for restaurants.

Today, the company continues investing heavily in warehouse systems, technology, logistics infrastructure, direct sourcing opportunities, quality control, and operational efficiency to position itself for the future.

While the company has grown significantly over nearly three decades, the foundation remains the same:

Work hard. Build relationships. Take care of customers. Continue growing.